



A Quick Look at Where Things Stand

Following up on our conversation — here's what I meant about not overpaying for this kind of work.

APRIL 2026

— THE PROBLEM

The current site doesn't match the product.

Whiskey JYPSI has earned Double Gold, Platinum, and 5-star reviews from the industry's toughest critics. But the website — the first place most customers encounter the brand — reads like a standard celebrity spirits template. No SEO foundation. No sensory storytelling. No conversion architecture. After our conversation this morning, I put together an independent analysis and a redesign concept to show what's possible and how quickly this kind of work can come together. Here's a look at the two approaches side by side.

— HEAD TO HEAD

Where each approach lands.

S ASSOC. VO	INDEPENDENT ANALYSIS
SEO FOUNDATION	
✓ Title tag, meta description, H1 targeting "small batch bourbon" (33K monthly searches). Eric Church in copy. Open Graph tags. JSON-LD schema. Canonical URL. Strong technical SEO — the current site has none of this.	✓ Full SEO parity: identical title tag, meta, H1, OG tags, JSON-LD schema for org + all three product lines, canonical URL. Eric Church in hero copy, product alt text, and footer. Keyword targeting throughout.
BRAND IDENTITY	

	✗ Text-only logo "WHISKEY JYPSI" in generic sans-serif. No JYPSI brand assets – no logo, gradient mark, or eye icon. Could be any whiskey brand with the name swapped in. Brand guideline gap.	✓ Actual JYPSI white logo in nav, gradient logo in footer. "Unbound by convention" brand line as hero statement. JYPSI Spirit background, eye icon DNA, Our Story imagery – all sourced directly from the brand.	
	VISUAL DESIGN		
	~ Self-described as "V0 – do not worry about how it looks." Generic dark theme, standard section layout. The cocktail photography carries the visual weight alone. Placeholder brackets where bottles and awards should be.	✓ Full design system: Cormorant Garamond + Barlow type pairing, gold/cream/copper palette, film-grain texture, ambient bottle glows, scroll-triggered reveals, hover interactions. Designed to compete with Clase Azul / Macallan tier sites.	
	PRODUCT PRESENTATION		
	~ Three products in a horizontal card row. 2-line descriptions each. No tasting notes, no proof/age specs, no per-product awards. Bottle images are placeholder brackets. Functional but thin.	✓ Two layers of product presentation. First: a shoppable three-across lifestyle grid using the cocktail photography – click any card and go straight to buy. Then below: full split-screen sections per product with actual bottles, ambient glow, tasting note tags, proof/age/method specs, per-product award badges, and dedicated CTAs. Browse-and-buy impulse + deep-dive storytelling.	
	CRITIC & SOCIAL PROOF		
	~ Three quotes from critics, but some appear paraphrased rather than verbatim. Awards mentioned in hero badges. No dedicated critics section.	✓ Six verbatim critic quotes in a dedicated grid section. Three full-width typographic quote breaks woven between products as scroll rhythm devices. All quotes verified against the live site.	
	LIFESTYLE & COCKTAILS		
	✓ Smart use of recent cocktail shoot photography. 6-image Instagram-style grid. Strong lifestyle content that the current site entirely lacks.	✓ Cocktail photography used in two places: the shoppable product grid (driving conversion) and a dedicated Instagram-style lifestyle grid lower on the page with @whiskeyjypsi tagging. The same photo assets work harder across the page.	
	VIDEO STRATEGY		

✓ Correctly identifies the 43-minute YouTube problem. Placeholder for a short-form embed. Good strategic call.

✓ Fred Minnick show featured in a dedicated split-screen section with click-to-play. Image thumbnail loads first, video embeds on click — fast page load.

EMAIL CAPTURE & COMMUNITY

✓ "10% off first order" lead magnet. Email input. Social media links to all four platforms. "9,700 strong" community stat. Good conversion thinking.

✓ Email capture section with the same community stat, all four social links, and the "Join the Band" language from the current site. Styled to match the design system.

CONVERSION ARCHITECTURE

✓ "Buy Now" in nav. "Shop the Collection" as primary hero CTA. Buy links per product. Direct link to buy.whiskeyjypi.com.

✓ "Buy Now" in nav. "Shop the Collection" hero CTA. Per-product "Get This Bottle" CTAs. All links point to buy.whiskeyjypi.com and real product pages. Persistent nav CTA on scroll.

MOBILE RESPONSIVE

~ Not evaluated in available V0.

✓ Full responsive breakpoint at 900px. Stacked layouts, collapsed nav, adjusted imagery for mobile. Tested in the mockup.

THE NET

The S Assoc. V0 identifies real SEO gaps — that's a solid diagnostic. The independent analysis takes a broader view, addressing both the technical SEO foundation *and* the brand expression challenge. It combines the SEO layer with a full design system, product presentation, and brand fidelity — incorporating strong elements from both approaches (the shoppable lifestyle grid, cocktail photography) into a cohesive experience. The audit, analysis, and redesign concept were all produced in a single working session.

— INDEPENDENT AUDIT

The numbers don't lie.

We ran a comprehensive SEO / GEO / AEO audit against whiskeyjypsi.com on April 3, 2026 — crawling 12 pages across the entire site. Here's how it scored.



Combined: 15 / 30. The brand has world-class product content and genuine authority signals — Eric Church, Ari Sussman, 70+ press placements, Double Gold and Platinum awards. But the technical foundation is suppressing all of it. Zero meta descriptions across all 12 pages. The homepage title reads "Home Page - Whiskey JYPSI." Four product pages are missing H1 tags. No Product schema, no FAQ schema, no Person schema for any of the three founders. The whiskey is exceptional — the site just isn't letting search engines or AI systems know that.

CRITICAL FINDINGS

What the audit found.

- Zero meta descriptions across all 12 pages**

Every Google impression shows an auto-generated snippet. This directly reduces click-through rate — highest-ROI fix available.
- Homepage title: "Home Page - Whiskey JYPSI"**

Wastes the most valuable keyword slot in the entire site. Should target "Award-Winning Small Batch Bourbon."
- 4 pages missing H1 tags — /whiskey/, /jypsi-spirit/, /tribute/, /barrel-seekers/**

Search engines can't identify the primary topic of these pages. Basic content hierarchy is broken.
- No Product schema on any product page**

Tribute, Explorer, Legacy, and Barrel Seekers all lack Product markup — no price, availability, or ratings in search results.
- No FAQ schema, no question-phrased headings — site-wide**

The brand has rich, answerable content but none of it is formatted for featured snippets or voice search. Invisible to answer engines.

No Person schema for Eric Church, Raj Alva, or Ari Sussman

AI engines can't confidently identify or cite the founders. Missing sameAs social links in Organization schema.

Brand pages are critically thin — /our-story/ (375 words), /jynsi-spirit/ (275 words)

These are the pages AI engines and journalists visit to understand the company. Both need 600+ words of substantive, factual content.

Image alt text: "starks logo" used across the entire site

A leftover placeholder from a prior theme. The brand name isn't reflected in its own logo alt text.

WHAT'S ALREADY STRONG

The foundation to build on.

Exceptional product factual density. Explorer lists exact mash bill (66% corn / 30% rye / 4% malted barley), proof (103), wood origins (Forest of Tronçais). Legacy Batch 001 specifies component percentages and ages. This is exactly what AI engines prefer to cite.

70+ press placements including Forbes, USA Today, Whisky Advocate, Esquire. 2024 Whiskey Maker of the Year. SF Double Gold, Ascot Platinum, 95-point Bottle Raiders score.

Named expert attribution. Ari Sussman is identified and quoted directly. Three named founders with real credentials — strongest E-E-A-T signal available in the celebrity spirits category.

Cherokee White Corn and cross-category blending are genuinely original narratives that differentiate from every competitor. AI engines prefer distinctive, citation-worthy content.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR THE BUSINESS

The whiskey sells itself. The site should too.

The audit reveals a clear pattern: the brand and the product are world-class, but the digital infrastructure is leaving money on the table at every layer.

0 / 12

Pages with meta descriptions — every Google impression shows an auto-generated snippet

4 / 10

AEO score — zero FAQ schema, zero question-phrased headings, invisible to voice and answer engines

15 / 30

Combined SEO/GEO/AEO score — significant upside available with targeted structural fixes

The redesign concept addresses these gaps at every layer — not just the visual experience, but the technical infrastructure underneath it:

- Proper title tags, meta descriptions, and H1s targeting "small batch bourbon" (33K monthly searches)
- Full JSON-LD schema: Organization with sameAs, Product schema for all three lines, structured review data
- Open Graph tags so every social share renders a branded preview with bottle imagery
- Eric Church's name in page copy and meta for the first time — unlocking 390+ monthly branded searches
- Tasting notes, product specs, and awards front-and-center — the exact factual density AI engines want to cite
- Shoppable lifestyle grid + deep product sections — browse-and-buy impulse meets editorial storytelling
- A design that matches the quality of a Double Gold whiskey — not a WordPress template

THE BOTTOM LINE

Whiskey JYPSI has a 6/10 GEO score despite having better raw material than most competitors — because the technical infrastructure isn't surfacing it. The brand is sitting on 70+ press placements, three named founders with real credentials, and genuinely original product stories. The technical SEO fixes are days of work. The schema gaps are days of work. And a design that matches the product quality can come together faster than you might expect. The product has already won. The site just needs to catch up.

See the full redesign concept.

The complete page — SEO foundation, brand design, bottles, cocktails, critics, video, email capture, and conversion architecture — built in an afternoon to show what's possible.

[VIEW THE REDESIGN](#)

[VIEW CURRENT SITE](#)